

Magnets

A magnet can push and pull objects without even touching them. It does this using an invisible force called magnetism, which is strongest at the two ends, or **poles**, of the magnet. Magnets only affect **magnetic materials**, such as iron, nickel, cobalt, and steel.

The two poles of a magnet are called its north (N) and south (S) poles. A curved magnet like this is known as a horseshoe magnet.

Is it magnetic?

Metals that contain iron are magnetic and will be attracted to a magnet. Other materials that do not contain iron, including most metals, will not be affected by a magnet.

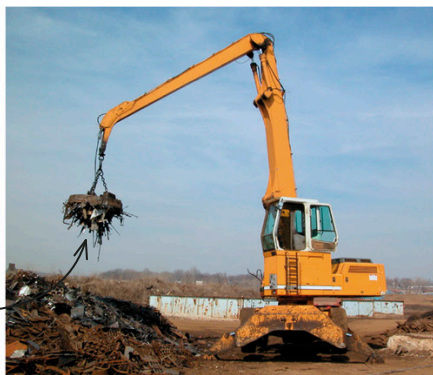
This plastic pen is not magnetic, so it's not attracted to the magnet.

This rubber does not contain magnetic material. It is not affected by the horseshoe magnet.

How strong are magnets?

Magnets can be incredibly strong. Some are so powerful that they can lift up very heavy items, such as cars.

This crane is using a magnet to lift heavy scrap metal.



This steel ruler is magnetic because it contains iron, which is attracted to the magnet.